

Joseph's Journey: From Slavery to Power

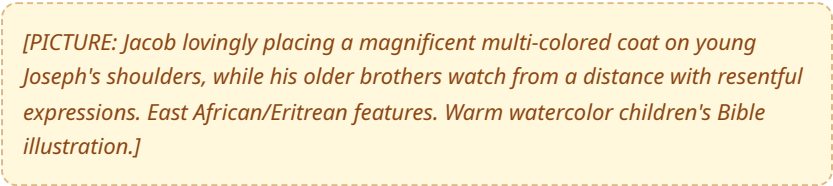
ገጽ 41 ከ 60 ገጾች ውስጥ

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 41 of 60

Scene 1 of 25



Jacob had twelve sons, but Joseph held a special place in his heart. He was the firstborn of Rachel, the wife Jacob had loved most deeply. To show his favor, Jacob gave Joseph a richly ornamented coat — a garment of many colors that set him apart from his brothers. This visible display of favoritism planted seeds of bitterness that would soon grow into something dangerous.

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(Ya'iqob aserte kilte deqi neberwo, gin Yosef filuy bota ab libu nebero.)

[PICTURE: Young Joseph excitedly telling his brothers about his dream, with sheaves of wheat bowing down to one standing sheaf. Brothers looking angry and dismissive. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Joseph had vivid dreams that seemed to carry divine significance. In one dream, he and his brothers were binding sheaves of grain in the field when suddenly his sheaf rose and stood upright, while their sheaves gathered around and bowed down to his. When Joseph naively shared this dream, his brothers' jealousy deepened into hatred. "Do you intend to reign over us?" they demanded. Joseph did not yet understand that speaking God's truth requires wisdom in timing.

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(Yosef amlakhawi tirqum zimesil nitsur hilmitat nebero.)

Scene 3 of 25

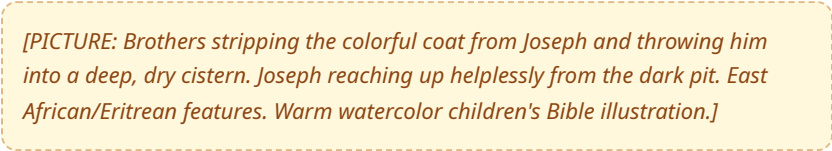
[PICTURE: Joseph having a second dream - the sun, moon, and eleven stars bowing before him, depicted in a night sky vision above his sleeping form. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

A second dream followed — even more provocative than the first. Joseph saw the sun, moon, and eleven stars all bowing down to him. Even his father Jacob rebuked him this time: "Shall your mother and I and your brothers actually come to bow down before you?" Yet Jacob quietly kept the matter in his heart, sensing perhaps that God was speaking through his young son. Sometimes divine purpose is revealed long before it is fulfilled, and patience is required of both the dreamer and those who hear.

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(Kal'ay hilmi se'abe — kab qedamay ziyada biduh.)

Scene 5 of 25



They seized Joseph, stripped him of his beloved coat, and threw him into an empty cistern — a deep pit with no water. Reuben, the eldest, had secretly planned to rescue him later, but the others felt no such mercy. As Joseph cried out from the darkness of that pit, his brothers sat down to eat their meal, unmoved by his pleas. How quickly jealousy can harden the human heart, turning brothers into enemies and love into cruelty.

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(Ni'Yosef hizom, fiqur qemishu qentitom, nab tiray gudguad derbeywo.)

Scene 6 of 25

[PICTURE: A caravan of Ishmaelite merchants with camels approaching, while brothers negotiate to sell Joseph. Joseph being pulled from the pit looking terrified. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

As they ate, a caravan of Ishmaelite merchants appeared on the horizon, their camels laden with spices bound for Egypt. Judah saw an opportunity: "What profit is it if we kill our brother? Let us sell him instead." For twenty pieces of silver — the price of a young slave — they sold their own flesh and blood. Joseph, barely seventeen years old, was torn from everything he knew and carried away toward a foreign land. The brothers watched the caravan disappear, not realizing they had just set in motion God's sovereign plan for the salvation of nations.

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(Ab zibelullu gize, nay Asma'elawyan negado nigdet ab bayta tera'aye.)

Scene 7 of 25

[PICTURE: Brothers dipping Joseph's colorful coat in goat's blood, then presenting it to their grieving father Jacob who tears his garments in anguish. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

To conceal their crime, the brothers slaughtered a goat and dipped Joseph's coat in its blood. They brought it to their father and said, "We found this. Examine it — is it your son's coat?" Jacob recognized it immediately and was shattered with grief. "A wild animal has devoured him!" he wailed. He tore his clothes, put on sackcloth, and mourned for many days. No one could comfort him. The brothers lived with their lie, watching their father suffer — a reminder that sin always produces consequences beyond what we imagine.

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(Gebenon limshifan, ahwat tel haridoom qemish Yosef ab demu temeqwo.)

Scene 8 of 25

[PICTURE: Joseph being sold at a slave market in Egypt, with Potiphar - a tall Egyptian official - purchasing him. Egyptian architecture and palm trees in the background. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

In Egypt, Joseph was sold to Potiphar, the captain of Pharaoh's guard — a powerful and wealthy official. Stripped of his identity, his family, and his freedom, Joseph faced a choice that would define his character: would he become bitter, or would he remain faithful? Despite every reason to despair, Joseph chose to serve with excellence. He decided that even as a slave, he would honor God through his work. This decision — made in the depths of suffering — would prove to be the foundation of everything God would build through him.

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(Ab Gibtsi Yosef ni'Potifar, haleqa halewa Fir'on — hayaln habtamn seb siltan — teshete.)

Scene 11 of 25

[PICTURE: Potiphar's wife holding Joseph's garment and accusing him before angry household servants, while Joseph is being led away in chains toward prison. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Humiliated by Joseph's rejection, Potiphar's wife twisted the truth into a weapon. She held up Joseph's garment and accused him of the very sin he had fled from. Potiphar, furious, had Joseph thrown into prison — the royal dungeon where the king's prisoners were confined. Joseph had done everything right and was punished for it. This is one of life's hardest lessons: doing the right thing does not guarantee immediate reward. Sometimes integrity leads to suffering before it leads to vindication. But God never wastes our pain.

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(Binetsegita Yosef zitewardet sebyeti Potifar haqi nab atswar qeyereta.)

[PICTURE: Joseph in a dark prison cell, yet standing tall with quiet dignity. Other prisoners around him, and the prison warden speaking to Joseph with respect. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Even in prison, Joseph refused to surrender to despair. The Lord remained with him and granted him favor in the eyes of the prison warden. Once again, Joseph's character shone through adversity. The warden put Joseph in charge of all the other prisoners, and everything in the prison was managed under Joseph's direction. The pattern was clear: wherever Joseph went, whatever his circumstances, God's presence and Joseph's faithfulness combined to produce excellence. Prison could confine his body but not his spirit or his God-given purpose.

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(Ab bet ma'eserti'wun Yosef nitesfa miqurats kisi'ar abeye.)

Scene 13 of 25

[PICTURE: Joseph sitting with two troubled men - Pharaoh's cupbearer and baker - in prison, listening intently to their dreams. Both men look worried and confused. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Two of Pharaoh's officials — the chief cupbearer and the chief baker — were thrown into the same prison after offending the king. One morning, Joseph noticed they both looked troubled. "Why are your faces so sad today?" he asked. They explained they had each dreamed a vivid dream but had no one to interpret them. Joseph replied with humble confidence: "Do not interpretations belong to God? Tell me your dreams." Even in his own suffering, Joseph noticed the pain of others and offered to help — a mark of true character.

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(Kilte seb siltan Fir'on — akbari tsiwa'in halaq senkatitin — ninigus dihri mighas nab temesasali bet ma'eserti tederbeyyu.)

Scene 16 of 25

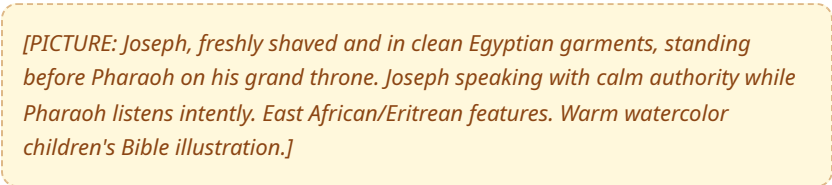
[PICTURE: Pharaoh tossing restlessly in his ornate bed, haunted by dreams of seven fat cows being devoured by seven thin cows, and seven full ears of grain consumed by seven thin ears. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then Pharaoh himself had two disturbing dreams that none of his magicians or wise men could interpret. In the first, seven fat, healthy cows emerged from the Nile, followed by seven gaunt, ugly cows that devoured them. In the second, seven plump heads of grain grew on a single stalk, then seven thin, scorched heads swallowed them up. Pharaoh was deeply troubled — he sensed these dreams carried a message of great importance. At last, the cupbearer remembered Joseph. "There was a Hebrew prisoner who interpreted my dream perfectly," he told Pharaoh. God's timing had arrived.

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(Dihr'iu Fir'on ba'lu kilte zeshaqilu hilmitat haleme zikone kab tenqoltu wey tibebeñatatu kitrigum zeyk'ale.)

Scene 17 of 25



Joseph was rushed from the dungeon. He shaved, changed his clothes, and was brought before Pharaoh. When Pharaoh said, "I have heard you can interpret dreams," Joseph immediately gave God the credit: "I cannot do it, but God will give Pharaoh the answer he desires." Joseph explained that both dreams shared one message: God was revealing what He was about to do. Seven years of unprecedented abundance would come to Egypt, followed by seven years of devastating famine so severe it would consume all memory of the plenty. Joseph spoke with authority that could only come from God — and Pharaoh recognized it.

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(Yosef kab bet ma'eserti tehawisu wetse. Telatsiyyu kidanu qeyiru qidmi Fir'on qerebe.)

Scene 20 of 25

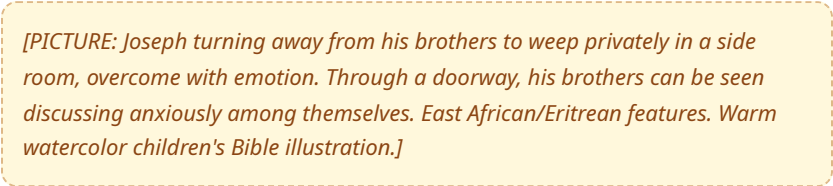
[PICTURE: Joseph's ten older brothers bowing before him in his Egyptian palace, not recognizing him. Joseph dressed in Egyptian royal attire looking down at them with concealed emotion. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When the famine struck, it devastated not only Egypt but surrounding nations, including Canaan where Jacob's family lived. Jacob sent ten of his sons to Egypt to buy grain. They came before Joseph — bowing with their faces to the ground, exactly as his childhood dream had foretold. Joseph recognized them instantly, but they did not recognize him. He was now Egyptian in appearance, language, and status — a world apart from the teenage brother they had sold. Joseph's heart must have raced, but he concealed his identity, speaking harshly and accusing them of being spies. He needed to know: had his brothers changed?

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(Timet mis weq'e ni'Gibtsi tiray aykonen ab zurya hageratwun ab Kene'an sidra Ya'iqob zinebiru zebare'e.)

Scene 21 of 25



Joseph tested his brothers through a series of trials. He kept Simeon as a prisoner and demanded they bring Benjamin — his only full brother — to prove they were not spies. When they finally returned with Benjamin, Joseph tested them further by planting his silver cup in Benjamin's sack and threatening to enslave him. This time, Judah — the very brother who had suggested selling Joseph — stepped forward and offered himself as a slave in Benjamin's place, pleading for his father's life. The brothers had changed. They would not abandon another of Rachel's sons. Repentance had done its work in their hearts.

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(Yosef ni'ahwatu bitekhtatali fetenattat fetenoom.)

Scene 25 of 25

[PICTURE: A panoramic scene showing Joseph's full journey - from the pit, to slavery, to prison, to the throne - depicted as a winding path leading upward. God's light shining over the entire journey. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Joseph's story is one of the most powerful testimonies of God's faithfulness in all of Scripture. A favored son became a slave, a slave became a prisoner, and a prisoner became the second most powerful man in the world — all according to God's perfect plan. Joseph endured betrayal, false accusation, and years of forgotten imprisonment, yet he never abandoned his faith or his integrity. His life teaches us that God is sovereign over every circumstance, that character built in darkness shines brightest in the light, and that true forgiveness has the power to restore what was broken. No matter what you face today, God is writing a story with your life that is bigger than your current chapter.

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(Tarikh Yosef ab kulu qidus tsihuf kab zihayelu miskrnetat nay Amlak mi'imannet hade iyu.)

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**"You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good
to accomplish what is now being done, the saving of
many lives."**

[illegible]

file:///projects/sandbox/children-bible-stories/books/book41_joseph_journey.html

Discussion Questions / ስላሳ ስላሳ ስላሳ

1. Joseph was faithful in every position — slave, prisoner, and ruler. How does your attitude toward small responsibilities reflect the kind of leader you might become? What does it mean to be faithful when no one is watching?
2. When Joseph was tempted by Potiphar's wife, he fled rather than fighting the temptation. In what situations might running away actually be the bravest choice? How can you prepare yourself in advance for moments of intense temptation?
3. Joseph waited thirteen years between receiving God's promise (his dreams) and seeing it fulfilled. Have you ever had to wait a long time for something you believed God promised? How do you maintain faith when God seems silent?
4. Joseph chose to forgive brothers who showed no remorse for over twenty years. Is forgiveness conditional on the other person apologizing? What does unforgiveness do to the person holding onto it? How is Joseph's forgiveness a picture of how God forgives us?
5. Joseph said God "meant it for good" — but does that mean God causes evil things to happen to us? How do you understand the difference between God causing suffering

and God using suffering? How does this change how you
view your own difficult experiences?

Prayer / ማጽናት

Sovereign Lord, thank You for the story of Joseph — a testimony that You are faithful even when life is unfair and confusing. Help me to trust Your timing when I cannot see Your plan. Give me the strength to maintain my integrity when I am tempted, the patience to endure when I am forgotten, and the courage to forgive when I am wronged.

Father, I confess that I sometimes struggle to believe You are working when my circumstances are painful. Teach me to see my trials as training ground, not punishment. Help me remember that You waste nothing — not my tears, not my waiting, not my pain.

Lord, make me like Joseph — faithful in small things, resistant to temptation, patient in suffering, and generous in forgiveness. Use every experience in my life — even the ones I would never choose — for Your greater purpose and for the good of others. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Joseph's Journey: From Slavery to Power

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